RONALD T. SOKA

NETWORK ENGINEER | NETWORK SECURITY | IT INFRASTRUCTURE & SOFTWARE

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Portfolio: tavadaish.github.io/ronald-soka-portfolio • GitHub: github.com/Tavadaish

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Network Engineer with a BSc Honours Degree in Software Engineering and experience supporting enterprise ICT infrastructure in a public-sector environment. Work spans headquarters, branch and international site connectivity; network security and IPsec VPNs; infrastructure monitoring and incident response; and data-centre operations. Brings a software-engineering perspective to systems support, technical documentation and web/application prototyping. Focused on secure, reliable services, methodical troubleshooting and practical solutions for the people and organisations that depend on technology.

CORE TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

Enterprise networking: LAN/WAN, routing and switching, VLANs, trunking, OSPF fundamentals, DHCP, NAT/PAT, branch-to-HQ connectivity and remote-site access.

Network security: Sophos RED, Sophos firewall environments, Cisco ASA, site-to-site IPsec VPNs, IKEv1/IKEv2, firewall policies, segmentation and access control.

Data-centre & infrastructure: Core switching, server connectivity, infrastructure refresh and relocation planning, VMware vSphere, availability and service validation.

Systems administration & IT support: End-user and desktop support, system troubleshooting, Windows/Active Directory fundamentals, installation and configuration support, and technical handover.

Software & web development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Vite, Next.js, Tailwind CSS and Supabase; practical application and website prototyping.

Operations & delivery: Infrastructure monitoring, anomaly detection, incident response, fault isolation, operational logs, change planning, documentation and stakeholder coordination.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network Engineer | Ministry responsible for ICT, Zimbabwe

Infrastructure Development & Management

- Support enterprise network infrastructure, connectivity and service availability across headquarters, regional and branch locations, and supported institutions.
- Monitor infrastructure health, identify anomalies, investigate network incidents, maintain operational logs and support timely escalation and service restoration.
- Troubleshoot routing, switching, VLANs, trunking, IP connectivity, DHCP, NAT/PAT, firewall policies, VPNs and remote-site access while considering security and service continuity.
- Support branch and international site connectivity, including Sophos RED-based remote-office links and Cisco ASA/IPsec VPN arrangements.
- Contribute to data-centre networking and infrastructure activities, including core network equipment changes, relocation coordination, server connectivity and post-change validation.
- Provide network and infrastructure support for business-critical platforms and initiatives, including Public Financial Management System (PFMS) services, SAP hosting environments, ZITF and stadium/event connectivity.
- Prepare technical documentation, incident communications, implementation and change plans, operational records and handover information for technical and operational stakeholders.

LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL COORDINATION

- Undertook acting responsibilities as Deputy Director and Southern Region Chief Engineer, supporting technical coordination, work prioritisation, operational oversight and reporting.
- Served as an industrial supervisor for students on attachment, providing technical guidance, task direction and workplace support.

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SELECTED PROJECTS | TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENTS | EDUCATION & DEVELOPMENT

SELECTED PROJECT EXPERIENCE

- **Branch-to-headquarters network connectivity —** Supported connectivity between branch offices and headquarters so staff at remote locations could reach approved central services. Work included checking the end-to-end service path, routing and reachability, access controls and service validation.
- **International site connectivity using Sophos RED —** Worked on connecting international offices to headquarters using Sophos Remote Ethernet Devices, with attention to remote-site connectivity, central firewall integration, routing, access policy and validation of required services.
- **Data-centre core network equipment relocation —** Contributed to moving core network equipment from an existing data-centre location to a new site. Focus areas included coordination of infrastructure dependencies, equipment connectivity, change sequencing and service checks after the move.
- **Restricted-access site-to-site IPsec VPN —** Worked on a Cisco ASA-based partner VPN approach that limited access to approved file servers rather than exposing the wider data-centre network. Emphasis was placed on scoped traffic, security policy and validation.
- **DMZ internet connectivity troubleshooting —** Used layered troubleshooting across upstream link status, route selection, NAT, firewall policy and return-path behaviour to isolate an outbound connectivity issue and validate the appropriate internet path.
- **Connectivity for business-critical platforms and major events —** Supported network and infrastructure connectivity associated with PFMS services, SAP hosting environments, ZITF and stadium/event connectivity, with attention to service readiness and operational coordination.

SOFTWARE & WEB DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS

- **Professional portfolio website —** Designed and published a responsive portfolio using React, Vite and Tailwind CSS, with GitHub Pages deployment, GitHub Actions automation, structured metadata and Google Search Console setup.
- **Personal finance application prototype —** Developing a web-based budgeting application using Next.js, Tailwind CSS and Supabase, with a focus on practical personal-finance workflows.

TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Networking & security: Cisco Catalyst and Nexus switching environments, Cisco ASA, Sophos firewall and RED, IPsec VPNs, VLANs, routing and switching. Infrastructure: VMware vSphere, server connectivity and data-centre operations. Development: React, Vite, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Supabase, HTML, CSS and JavaScript. DevOps learning: Docker, Kubernetes and Google Cloud (ongoing study).

EDUCATION

BSc Honours Degree in Software Engineering — Zimbabwe Open University

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

• Digital Marketing — School of Java (2022)	• Cisco Cybersecurity Essentials — Cisco Networking Academy (2022)
• Cisco Cybersecurity Operations — Cisco Networking Academy (2022)	• Diploma in Information Technology Support (2024)
• Agile Project Management (2024)	• Diploma in Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) (2024)
• Diploma in Interconnecting Cisco Networking Devices Part 2 (ICND2) v3 — CCNA (2025)	• VMware vSphere (2026)
• Diploma in DevOps Engineering — Kubernetes, Docker and Google Cloud (ongoing)	• CCNA 200-301 study / recertification (ongoing)

Note: *Professional development items are listed using the qualification names and completion status supplied. Confirm awarding bodies and exact certificate titles before submitting to a specific employer.*